

WOOCOMMERCE · PERFORMANCE

7 fixes for a **slow** WooCommerce store.

No bigger server needed.
In the order I'd apply them.

Swipe for all 7 →



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01

Add a persistent object cache

WooCommerce repeats the same database queries on every page load. Without an object cache, MySQL answers them again and again.

DO THIS

Install Redis on the server, then the Redis Object Cache plugin. Check the hit rate in its dashboard.



02

Serve full-page cache to guests

Most visitors are not logged in and see identical pages. Building them from PHP each time wastes the server.

DO THIS

Cache guest pages at server level (Nginx FastCGI, LiteSpeed) and exclude cart, checkout and my-account.



03

Turn on HPOS

Old order storage puts every order field in `wp_postmeta`, one of the busiest tables on the site.

DO THIS

WooCommerce → Settings → Advanced →
Features: enable High-Performance Order Storage.
Test on staging first.



04

Replace WP-Cron with real cron

WP-Cron runs on page visits, so heavy scheduled tasks slow down real customers.

DO THIS

Set `DISABLE_WP_CRON` to true in `wp-config.php` and run `wp-cron.php` from a system cron every minute.



05

Audit plugins with Query Monitor

One bad plugin can add hundreds of queries per page. You won't know which without measuring.

DO THIS

Install Query Monitor, open your slowest pages, sort by component, remove or replace the worst offender.



06

Fix your images

Product photos are usually the heaviest part of a page, especially on mobile.

DO THIS

Serve WebP or AVIF, upload at display size, and set width and height to stop layout shift.



07

Load cart fragments only where needed

Some themes still request cart fragments on every page, an uncached AJAX call per visit.

DO THIS

If your mini-cart doesn't need live updates, dequeue `wc-cart-fragments` outside shop pages.



RECAP

Start with #1 and #2.

Object cache plus page cache fix most slow stores before you touch anything else.



Save this for your next store audit



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